State of Louisiana

Strategic IT Landscape and Market Analysis Report

SLG Strategy Team

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1. Executive Summary & Macro Landscape

The State of Louisiana is currently navigating a profound and accelerated macroeconomic, political, and administrative transformation under the leadership of Governor Jeff Landry. Taking office with a decisive mandate for systemic reform, fiscal conservatism, and aggressive economic expansion, the Landry administration has rapidly shifted the state's operational posture away from a legacy, highly bureaucratic model toward a highly agile, pro-business, and technology-forward enterprise.[1] Over the past year, Louisiana has enacted historic tax cuts, streamlined onerous business regulations, and successfully pivoted its economic narrative from a traditional, long-standing reliance on fossil fuel extraction and petrochemical production to establishing the state as a burgeoning epicenter for advanced digital infrastructure, artificial intelligence, and high-performance computing.[1] This aggressive paradigm shift is evidenced by monumental private-sector capital injections, most notably including Meta's $10 billion data center development project in Richland Parish and Hut 8's massive $10 billion artificial intelligence data center campus located in West Feliciana Parish.[4]

Politically, the state operates under a cohesive conservative power structure that heavily prioritizes rapid execution, operational efficiency, and the ruthless elimination of governmental bloat and technical debt. The administration's hallmark "Positioning Louisiana to Win" legislative mandate, officially codified as Act 590 of the 2024 Regular Legislative Session, perfectly exemplifies this ethos. Act 590 fundamentally reorganized the state's economic development efforts, allowing specific agencies to operate "at the speed of business" by bypassing traditional, slow-moving state procurement and centralized IT bottlenecks.[4] This macro environment presents a highly fertile, albeit complex, landscape for enterprise technology vendors. State leadership is acutely aware that realizing its grand economic ambitions requires the immediate modernization of its underlying digital, administrative, and workforce infrastructure to support incoming corporate investments.

For the current and upcoming fiscal years, the Landry administration has delineated the following core administrative goals, each carrying significant downstream implications for state and local government (SLG) technology spending:

Economic Development and Innovation Diversification: The administration is aggressively pushing to establish Louisiana as the preeminent technological and industrial power leader of the Southeast. This goal is spearheaded by the newly formed Louisiana Innovation (LA.IO) division within the Louisiana Economic Development (LED) department. LA.IO oversees a $50 million venture capital fund and is currently developing the Louisiana Institute for Artificial Intelligence. This institute is designed to serve as an anchor for applied research and commercialization, with a specific, funded mandate to equip 5,000 small and medium-sized businesses across the state with modern AI tools.[9] The state views AI not merely as an operational tool, but as a critical economic driver necessary to compete with neighboring tech hubs in Texas and Georgia.

Public Safety and Criminal Justice Reform: A foundational cornerstone of the governor's

political platform, the state has championed unyielding law enforcement support and stringent criminal justice reforms aimed at systemic accountability. This initiative has already yielded a reported 43% drop in violent crime in major municipalities such as New Orleans, driving parallel investments into justice technology modernization. The state is actively funding data-sharing partnerships, such as the collaboration between the Louisiana Department of Health (LDH) and the Office of Motor Vehicles (OMV), alongside the deployment of interagency analytics platforms, uniform charge tables, and modernized police records management systems to create a unified, real-time public safety apparatus.[1]

Workforce Modernization and Digital Equity: Recognizing that historic, multi-billion-dollar corporate tech investments require a highly skilled, modern labor pool, the state is completely overhauling its fragmented workforce development system. The flagship "One Door" initiative seeks to dramatically streamline citizen access to job training and public benefits. This requires modernizing the Louisiana Workforce Commission (recently rebranded as Louisiana Works), breaking down deeply entrenched legacy data silos between disparate agencies, and deploying modern, integrated eligibility systems to ensure that citizens transitioning off public assistance can seamlessly enter high-tech vocational training programs.[15]

Citizen Experience and Legacy System Eradication: The administration has declared an open war on technical debt, fragile legacy infrastructure, and inefficient citizen services. This is most visibly demonstrated by the governor's emergency declaration to completely overhaul the Office of Motor Vehicles (OMV). The state aggressively bypassed standard, protracted procurement cycles to eradicate a failing, 50-year-old IBM mainframe in favor of modern, cloud-native Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) solutions. This executive mandate was driven by the necessity to drastically reduce citizen wait times, eliminate catastrophic system outages, and introduce automated, AI-driven fraud prevention into fundamental state services.[19]

2. Power Structure & Key Stakeholders

The technological and financial trajectory of the State of Louisiana is dictated by a bifurcated power structure consisting of elected legislative and executive leadership, alongside appointed, highly specialized IT governance officials. Understanding the distinct delineation between "Financial Purchasers"—those who appropriate capital funds, sign executive mandates, and drive structural policy changes—and "Technical Influencers"—those who architect the enterprise environments, establish security baselines, and deploy the actual hardware and software—is critical for sophisticated account planning and strategic alignment.

The recent influx of private-sector executives into top public-sector IT roles signals a dramatic shift in how Louisiana intends to procure, manage, and scale its technology portfolio.

Name & Title	Recent Public Stances on Technology
Jeff Landry Governor, State of Louisiana	Operates as a relentless champion of sweeping modernization, technical debt eradication, and pro-growth policies. Issued unprecedented executive orders to aggressively replace legacy mainframes at the OMV following systemic failures. Signed Act 590 to intentionally bypass traditional IT procurement bottlenecks, signaling a willingness to override bureaucratic norms to achieve technological and economic velocity.[1]
Jack McFarland Chair, House Appropriations Committee	Focuses intensely on fiscal responsibility and scrutinizes the usage of the state general fund. Presides over the highly influential Joint Legislative Committee on the Budget (JLCB), holding ultimate legislative authority over the approval of IT modernization project funding, agency budget requests, and the review of large-scale, multi-year IT contracts.[23]
Glen Womack Committee Chair, Senate Finance	Oversees the macro appropriation of state funds and budgetary requirements within the Senate. Instrumental in advancing the governor's flat-funded executive budget and ensuring that recurring operational expenditures are minimized in favor of efficiency-driving, one-time capital investments.[27]
Mike Reese Vice Chair, Joint Legislative Committee on Technology and Cybersecurity	Evaluates statewide technology policy, cybersecurity posture, and infrastructure capabilities. Highly influential in the legislative review of centralized IT operations, disaster recovery preparedness, and the ongoing audit of the state's consolidated IT service delivery model.[30]
Josh Carlson Representative, Joint Legislative Committee on Technology and Cybersecurity	Highly influential in the legislative review of statewide technology policy, cybersecurity posture, and IT governance alongside his Senate counterparts.[32]
Evelina Broussard Chief Information Officer (CIO), Office of Technology Services (OTS)	Appointed in February 2025. Brings 28 years of rigorous private-sector experience from Atmos Energy, marking a departure from career bureaucrats. Strongly advocates for a unified "One Team" approach, focusing entirely on improving customer service, modernizing service delivery, increasing operational observability,

Name & Title	Recent Public Stances on Technology
	and mending deep-seated financial friction between OTS and its client state agencies.[34]
Chase Hymel Chief Information Security Officer (CISO), OTS	Focuses inward on the enterprise security architecture of executive branch state agencies. Responsible for zero-trust implementation, enterprise secure baseline migration, StateRAMP compliance enforcement, and managing the internal security operations center across the consolidated IT environment.[36]
Susan B. Bourgeois Secretary, Louisiana Economic Development (LED)	Leads the state's aggressive economic overhaul. Successfully secured an unprecedented legislative exemption from OTS oversight to move technology initiatives at the "speed of business." Architect of the LA.IO innovation brand and heavily involved in data center attraction, venture capital fund deployment, and AI institute funding.[7]
Bryan Adams Commissioner, Office of Motor Vehicles (OMV)	Tasked directly by the Governor to completely overhaul the failing OMV infrastructure. Successfully navigated emergency procurement protocols to replace a 50-year-old mainframe with cloud-native SaaS solutions to drastically improve the citizen experience and ensure continuous uptime.[19]
Rebecca Harris Secretary, Department of Children and Family Services (DCFS)	Leading a massive, highly complex digital transformation within DCFS. Spearheading the procurement and deployment of a new Comprehensive Child Welfare Information System (CCWIS) and child support enforcement systems to replace heavily siloed, legacy architecture.[38]

The deep analysis of this political and technological power structure reveals a distinct, highly actionable dynamic for enterprise vendors. Governor Landry favors rapid, decisive action over protracted, bureaucratic processes. If a technology solves an immediate political or citizen-facing crisis, the executive branch will find a mechanism to fund and deploy it. The appointment of Evelina Broussard—a seasoned private-sector energy executive—as the state CIO strongly signals a mandate to run the Office of Technology Services more like a corporate IT service provider focused on measurable customer satisfaction, and significantly less like a rigid government monopoly.[34]

Furthermore, the state's cybersecurity posture is managed by CISO Chase Hymel, who focuses on managing the internal hygiene and compliance of state agency networks and demonstrates a highly mature approach to enterprise cyber risk management.[41] Vendors must tailor their

messaging accordingly: Hymel requires deeply integrated, enterprise-grade network security and compliance telemetry for the centralized state data centers.

3. IT Governance & Service Delivery Model

Operating Model: Consolidated with Emerging Structural Fractures

Since the landmark passage of the IT Consolidation Act in 2014, the State of Louisiana has operated under a heavily **Consolidated** IT service delivery model governed centrally by the Office of Technology Services (OTS), which resides within the Division of Administration.[42] Prior to 2014, the state utilized a highly federated model characterized by severe duplication of effort, decentralized and redundant procurement, and disparate, uncommunicative data architectures. The massive consolidation effort transitioned the state to a shared infrastructure services model, centralizing thousands of IT staff, hardware procurement, software licensing, and a single project management office directly under the purview of the state CIO.[42]

Currently, OTS manages the state's core technology infrastructure across two primary state data centers, utilizing an active-active disaster recovery posture to ensure continuity of operations. The primary data center houses a legacy IBM z14 mainframe featuring 3,971 MIPS, while the secondary site utilizes an IBM z13s serving as a capacity backup machine. Both facilities support a massive Hyper-Converged Infrastructure (HCI) environment comprising over 160 hosts, supporting approximately 5,000 physical and virtual servers, and managing over 11 petabytes of unstructured and structured storage.[44] OTS also orchestrates hybrid cloud environments utilizing Amazon Web Services (AWS) and Microsoft Azure. To manage legacy infrastructure that cannot natively migrate to the public cloud, the state has actively deployed Azure Arc to gain full visibility and control, standardizing security patching and governance across on-premises and cloud environments.[44]

However, the rigidity of this decade-old consolidated model is currently being fundamentally challenged by the Landry administration's push for unprecedented operational velocity. The most significant structural fracture in the consolidated model is the passage of Act 590 during the 2024 Regular Legislative Session. This act explicitly and legally exempted the Louisiana Economic Development (LED) department from the oversight and procurement authority of the CIO and OTS, mandating a complete transition plan to separate their IT functions by June 2025.[7] This unprecedented legislative carve-out establishes a new **Hybrid** reality for the state. It signals that highly prioritized, economic-facing agencies may be granted the autonomy to procure, architect, and deploy advanced technology outside the centralized OTS infrastructure to avoid perceived bureaucratic bottlenecks. This creates distinct, separate buying centers within the state government that vendors must navigate independently.

Friction Points and Chargeback Mechanisms

The Office of Technology Services operates as an ancillary agency; it does not receive a direct state appropriation from the general fund for its internal operations. Instead, it relies entirely on a **fee-for-service chargeback model**, recovering its massive operational costs through

inter-agency transfers and self-generated funds billed directly to the consuming executive branch departments.[43]

This specific financial structure has been a profound source of long-standing operational friction. A highly critical performance audit conducted by the Louisiana Legislative Auditor previously chronicled severe agency dissatisfaction with OTS. The report highlighted a lack of accountability, poor communication, the absence of a comprehensive service catalog, and a fundamental inability to accurately track the costs and implementation progress of varying IT projects.[47] Because individual agencies are billed directly out of their own budgets for their consumption of central IT resources, the lack of granular visibility into exactly what they are paying for—coupled with the perceived sluggishness of centralized service delivery—has historically created a highly adversarial relationship between OTS and its "customers."

To mathematically mitigate this friction, OTS deployed Splunk Enterprise to aggregate massive datasets from various network and storage sources to analyze capacity and definitively track which agencies are utilizing specific services. This data-driven approach aims to resolve billing anomalies, justify the chargeback rates, and improve the accuracy of the recovery process.[48] Furthermore, under the new leadership of CIO Evelina Broussard, OTS has launched a strategic initiative specifically focused on "Financial Operations." The newly published OTS Strategic Plan (FY26-FY31) includes the mandated deployment of a modernized customer billing portal. This portal will allow agencies direct, transparent access to their IT invoices and usage summaries. Additionally, OTS has established a rigorous internal mandate to identify and resolve 85% of billing anomalies within two business days.[49] Broussard's public stance emphasizing that OTS and the constituent agencies are "One Team" is a direct, highly strategic maneuver intended to repair this deeply entrenched interagency friction and restore trust in the consolidated model.[34]

4. Financials & Budget Breakdown

Total & IT Budget

The macroeconomic fiscal posture of the State of Louisiana is currently defined by a strict commitment to flat-funding, structural bureaucratic reform, and the realization that the state must wean itself off the artificial budget surpluses created by expiring COVID-19 federal stimulus funds. For the Fiscal Year 2025-2026 (FY26), Governor Landry's Executive Budget recommends a total state spending plan of **$47.96 billion**. This represents a highly intentional reduction from the artificially inflated budgets of previous pandemic-era years. Of this massive total, **$12.21 billion** is derived directly from the State General Fund (Direct), with the remainder sourced from complex federal receipts, statutory dedications, and agency self-generated revenues.[51]

Within this broader macroeconomic framework, the **Office of Technology Services (OTS)** has a recommended total budget of **$670,741,095** for FY26. This figure actually represents a decrease of approximately $28.7 million from the Existing Operating Budget (EOB) of FY25,

reflecting the administration's mandate to find efficiencies and reduce centralized overhead.[52] Because OTS functions as an ancillary agency, this entire $670.7 million is generated via the aforementioned inter-agency chargeback mechanisms rather than through direct general fund appropriations.[46]

O&M vs. Capital Expenditures: *Data Unavailable*. The exact, itemized internal expenditure breakdown delineating recurring operational spend (Operations & Maintenance) versus net-new capitalized IT project investments within the $670.7 million OTS budget is heavily obscured within the public ancillary appropriation documents.[52] The state does not publicly publish the granular software licensing versus hardware procurement split within the OTS operating budget.

However, external agency budgets clearly indicate that significant capital is currently being funneled into net-new technology modernization projects. For instance, the Department of Motor Vehicles modernization project alone represents a massive **$54 million** capital infusion over six years.[19] Furthermore, the state's Capital Outlay budget contains over **$2.89 billion** in broad infrastructure spending for FY26. While specific IT line items within the capital outlay are generally aggregated into broader facility and operational upgrades, this represents a massive pool of funding for intelligent edge, physical security, and infrastructure modernization tied to facility renovations.[54]

Grants & Funding Influxes

Despite the purposeful reduction in broad pandemic-era stimulus, Louisiana is aggressively and surgically leveraging targeted federal grants and dedicated funds to subsidize its technology, AI, and cybersecurity modernization efforts without burdening the state general fund:

- **State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP):** Funded by the bipartisan Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (IIJA), Louisiana has been allocated **$1,637,992** specifically for FY25 to manage and aggressively reduce systemic cyber risks across state, local, and territorial networks.[55] The state requires a 40% non-federal cost match for the FY25 allocation.[56] State emergency and security officials utilize these specific funds to foster a whole-of-state cyber resilience posture, expanding the state's security perimeter to include historically vulnerable local municipalities, county governments, and critical infrastructure operators who lack the tax base to fund their own cyber defenses.
- **Rural Health Transformation & Sustainability Grants:** The Louisiana Department of Health (LDH) is aggressively pursuing massive Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) funding to completely overhaul its rural health networks. Spanning a performance period from 2026 to 2031, these funds will indirectly drive massive requirements for modernized telehealth infrastructure, interoperable electronic health records (EHR), and secure, highly available edge computing at rural healthcare facilities to support advanced remote care services and secure data sharing.[57]
- **Louisiana Growth Fund (Federal SSBCI):** Utilizing federal State Small Business Credit Initiative funding, the state has launched a **$50 million** initial venture fund operating

under the new LA.IO innovation division. This capital is specifically earmarked to scale high-growth, technology-enabled startups. Crucially, private equity and incubator partners are expected to match this funding, bringing the total investment pool to $100 million. This functions as a massive catalyst for expanding the state's commercial digital footprint, driving regional compute consumption, and fostering a homegrown technology ecosystem.[10]

5. Strategic Initiatives & Projects (Focus on Top 3)

The Landry administration's aggressive posture on modernization and its zero-tolerance policy for failing legacy infrastructure has catalyzed several massive, highly funded IT overhauls. The following represent the top three strategic initiatives currently dominating the state's technology landscape, each representing multi-million-dollar modernization efforts:

Initiative 1: OMV Legacy Mainframe Eradication and Digital Transformation

- **The Executive Mandate:** Driven directly by Governor Landry through multiple, highly publicized executive orders, this modernization initiative was born out of an absolute operational crisis. A 50-year-old, "green-screen" legacy mainframe suffered catastrophic failures resulting in 60 days of systemic downtime, effectively crippling citizen services and resulting in a political firestorm.[19] The executive mandate is strictly focused on drastically improving the citizen experience, cutting unacceptable wait times, and eliminating decades of accrued technical debt.[21]
- **The Specific High-Spend Agency Owning It:** The Office of Motor Vehicles (OMV), operating under the Department of Public Safety (DPS), in highly structured partnership with OTS. The state rapidly bypassed standard procurement to award a **$54 million**, six-year modernization contract to execute this vision.[19]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** The state requires a complete, aggressive rip-and-replace of its legacy mainframe architecture in favor of a modern, highly resilient, cloud-native Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) platform. Awarded to CHAMP Titles, the solution involves migrating both Vehicle Services and Driver Services to a digital system of record. This new architecture utilizes artificial intelligence tools for real-time fraud prevention and automated verification.[19] A critical, non-negotiable underlying IT requirement dictated by the state is absolute data sovereignty and ownership. This necessitates robust cloud storage architecture, highly secure data migration protocols as the 1970s-era system is finally sunset, and the integration of performance monitoring to ensure the new platform never experiences the latency of its predecessor.[19]

Initiative 2: Comprehensive Child Welfare Information System (CCWIS) & Workforce Modernization

- **The Executive Mandate:** The Department of Children and Family Services (DCFS) is

currently operating under a newly published strategic business plan designed to fundamentally transform departmental accountability, operational excellence, and data-driven policymaking. Concurrently, the state is launching the "One Door" initiative to streamline access to job training by breaking down silos between DCFS and the Louisiana Workforce Commission.[17] The current legacy systems are disjointed, heavily siloed, and fail to effectively manage the complex lifecycle of child welfare and workforce enablement.

- **The Specific High-Spend Agency Owning It:** The Department of Children and Family Services (DCFS), led by Secretary Rebecca Harris, working in tandem with the Louisiana Workforce Commission (Louisiana Works).
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** DCFS issued aggressive Requests for Information (RFIs) in late 2025 seeking a comprehensive, all-in-one system solution to replace its legacy child welfare and child support enforcement systems. The state requires a massive solution that complies with stringent federal Office of Child Support Systems (OCSS) requirements, with the actual project implementation slated to begin in July 2026 and achieve full operational capacity by October 2027.[39] This necessitates massive unstructured data cleansing of legacy records, the establishment of a highly secure cloud-based interagency analytics platform, and the complex integration of a new Enterprise Service Bus (ESB) to ensure interoperability with the Louisiana Department of Health's Medicaid systems (the LITE system).[14] The underlying infrastructure requires vast, highly secure storage capabilities, StateRAMP-compliant cloud hosting, and robust identity and access management (IAM) to protect highly sensitive citizen data.

Initiative 3: Louisiana Institute for Artificial Intelligence (LA.IO) and Tech Hub Expansion

- **The Executive Mandate:** As part of the state's massive macroeconomic pivot, the Louisiana Economic Development (LED) department has been mandated to build the most robust, innovative, and dynamic economy in the Southeast. To achieve this, the state is heavily subsidizing and facilitating the creation of massive tech hubs, gigawatt-scale data centers, and an applied AI research institute to physically equip 5,000 small and medium businesses with artificial intelligence tools to boost productivity.[9]
- **The Specific High-Spend Agency Owning It:** Louisiana Economic Development (LED), operating through its new LA.IO division. Crucially, this initiative is utilizing its Act 590 legislative exemption from standard OTS procurement constraints, allowing it to purchase advanced technology rapidly and independently.[7]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** This initiative represents a massive, unprecedented surge in High-Performance Computing (HPC) and AI-ready infrastructure requirements across the state. The state is actively facilitating $20 billion in private data center investments (such as Meta and Hut 8).[5] Simultaneously, the state's university and research networks (such as LSU and Tulane) are rapidly expanding their GPU clusters to

support this AI ecosystem. Current state research computing relies heavily on complex architecture, such as AMD EPYC CPUs, NVIDIA A100/H100 GPUs, and massive parallel storage systems (e.g., DDN) to support deep learning, AI model training, and complex computational modeling.[59] The underlying IT requirement for the state to support the LA.IO institute is the rapid procurement and deployment of dense, liquid-cooled, AI-optimized compute nodes, vast unstructured data storage (Data Lakes), and advanced energy-aware orchestration software to manage the immense, multi-megawatt power demands of these specific clusters.[61]

6. Procurement, Vendor Landscape, & Compliance

Procurement Vehicles and Preferred Purchasing Methods

The State of Louisiana leverages a highly sophisticated, multi-tiered matrix of centralized procurement and cooperative purchasing agreements to streamline complex IT acquisitions. This process is managed predominantly by the Office of State Procurement (OSP), with distinct new exceptions for economic development:

- **NASPO ValuePoint:** This is the primary, preferred cooperative vehicle utilized by the state for tier-one technology, hardware, and infrastructure purchases. Dell Technologies holds a highly lucrative, active Master Agreement and State Participating Addendum (Contract #4400028252) specifically for Computer Equipment, Peripherals, and Related Services. This critical contract is currently set to expire on **June 30, 2026**, creating a compelling event for large-scale infrastructure refreshes prior to the deadline.[62]
- **OMNIA Partners:** The state widely utilizes OMNIA for broad public sector procurement, including hardware, software licensing, and specialized IT consulting services. This provides an alternative, rapid-procurement pathway specifically favored by higher education institutions (like LSU) and quasi-governmental agencies.[62]
- **LaPAC & LaMAS:** The Louisiana Procurement and Contract Network (LaPAC) serves as the centralized digital portal for all competitive, open-market solicitations (RFPs/ITBs). The state also frequently utilizes Louisiana Multiple Award Schedules (LaMAS), which effectively mirror federal GSA pricing to ensure the state receives highly competitive rates.[66]
- **The Act 590 Exception:** As previously noted, LED is now legally exempt from OTS procurement oversight. This means that massive, large-scale technology purchases aligned directly with economic development and the LA.IO AI initiative may completely bypass standard centralized IT reviews, moving directly through LED or its private-sector advisory board. This represents a massive shift in how vendors must engage the state.[7]

The Battlefield: Incumbents and Infrastructure Vulnerabilities

Louisiana's IT landscape is heavily entrenched with massive legacy vendors and complex infrastructure, creating a highly competitive battlefield ripe for technological displacement:

- **Compute & Storage Footprint:** The core state data centers rely heavily on massive Hyper-Converged Infrastructure (HCI) utilizing VMware. The competitive storage landscape is dense; the state maintains established, active NASPO contracts with Pure Storage and Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE), alongside Dell, creating constant competitive friction for array refreshes and capacity expansions.[44]
- **Legacy Mainframe Vulnerability:** While the OMV successfully eradicated its mainframe, the state remains deeply tethered to IBM across other critical agencies. OTS continues to operate an IBM z14 and a capacity-backup IBM z13s in its primary and secondary data centers.[44] The highly publicized, political success of the OMV mainframe eradication signifies a massive, systemic vulnerability for IBM, as the state legislature is now actively hostile toward maintaining fragile legacy systems and is aggressively seeking cloud-native or modern hybrid replacements.
- **Data & Analytics Dominance:** Splunk is deeply, fundamentally entrenched within OTS. It serves as the primary, highly customized tool for aggregating statewide network data, monitoring system capacity, and driving the mathematically complex internal billing and chargeback model that funds the entirety of OTS operations.[48]
- **Networking & Edge Instability:** Lumen Technologies (formerly CenturyLink), headquartered in Monroe, Louisiana, has historically dominated the state's networking and telecom footprint. However, Lumen recently executed a massive corporate restructuring, selling its consumer ILEC business to Apollo (operating as Brightspeed) while attempting to retain its enterprise fiber network. Concurrently, AT&T is acquiring a massive portion of Lumen's core network assets.[68] This severe corporate restructuring creates massive potential instability for state networking contracts and presents a rare, highly lucrative opportunity to aggressively introduce modern SD-WAN, edge computing, and secure access service edge (SASE) solutions.

Compliance Drivers

All enterprise technology purchases within Louisiana are strictly gated by rigorous, non-negotiable regulatory and compliance frameworks:

- **StateRAMP / GovRAMP Mandates:** Louisiana aggressively mandates that *all* cloud service providers (CSPs) and vendors processing, storing, or transmitting state government data must achieve StateRAMP (recently rebranded as GovRAMP) authorization. This requires strict, documented compliance with NIST Special Publication 800-53 (Rev 4 and transitioning to Rev 5) and continuous, expensive monitoring by a certified Third-Party Assessment Organization (3PAO).[70]
- **Federal Interoperability Mandates:** Massive modernization projects like the DCFS CCWIS overhaul must adhere strictly to the federal Office of Child Support Systems (OCSS) security standards.[58] Concurrently, the massive LDH rural health initiatives require absolute, documented adherence to HIPAA and CMS data interoperability rules, strictly governing how unstructured healthcare data is stored and transmitted across the state.[57]
- **AI Governance and Sovereign Cloud Mandates:** Governor Landry recently signed an

executive order strictly banning Communist Chinese AI platforms, specifically naming DeepSeek, from Louisiana government systems to protect against espionage and data theft. This creates a massive regulatory driver for sovereign, on-premises AI solutions and strict data governance.

7. Actionable Dell Opportunities (The "So What")

Based on the deep synthesis of Louisiana's massive macroeconomic shifts, the intentional fracturing of its consolidated IT governance model under Act 590, and the unprecedented influx of capital earmarked specifically for modernization and AI, the following represent highly actionable, immediate sales motions for the Dell Technologies account team and district leadership.

Funded Alignment: Capitalizing on the AI Gold Rush and LED Independence

The creation of the LA.IO initiative and the state's aggressive facilitation of $20 billion in private AI data center investments (Meta, Hut 8) represents the largest, most highly funded compute opportunity in the state's modern history. Crucially, because the Louisiana Economic Development (LED) department is now legally exempt from OTS procurement bottlenecks via Act 590, Dell can completely bypass the traditional, slow-moving centralized IT bureaucracy to sell advanced infrastructure directly to LED and its consortium of university partners.

- **The Motion:** The Dell Account Executive must immediately engage Josh Fleig (Chief Innovation Officer at LED) and the newly formed Louisiana Economic Development Partnership board. Position **Dell PowerEdge XE servers** (configured specifically with NVIDIA H100/B200 GPUs) and **PowerScale** unstructured data storage as the foundational, required architecture for the new Louisiana Institute for Artificial Intelligence. Align Dell's **AI-Ready Infrastructure** directly with the Governor's specific, funded mandate to equip 5,000 SMBs with scalable AI tools. By utilizing the existing Dell NASPO contract, LED can rapidly procure the massive high-performance computing (HPC) clusters required to launch this institute before the end of FY26, avoiding a protracted RFP process.

Competitive Displacement: The Mainframe Exodus and Hybrid Cloud Intercept The highly successful, emergency-mandated eradication of the 50-year-old OMV mainframe has broken the psychological and political barrier regarding legacy systems in Louisiana. However, the state's core data centers still harbor aging IBM z14 and z13s mainframes, alongside vast, highly complex deployments of VMware-based HCI.[44] Furthermore, the state relies heavily on Azure Arc to manage legacy systems that cannot natively migrate to the public cloud due to data gravity or security concerns.[45]

- **The Motion:** Aggressively attack the remaining IBM mainframe footprint within the Department of Revenue (which is currently expanding its digital tax mandates) and the core OTS data centers. Position **Dell APEX** as the ultimate, financially flexible hybrid-cloud bridge. As Louisiana struggles with the unpredictable, escalating costs of

public cloud repatriation and the immense complexity of managing 11 petabytes of on-premises storage, APEX offers the financial OpEx flexibility of the cloud combined with the security and data sovereignty of on-premises control. Furthermore, aggressively target the incumbent **Pure Storage** and **HPE** footprints within the state's massive HCI environment. Leverage Dell's **PowerStore** architecture, emphasizing its superior NVMe performance, native data reduction, and seamless integration with existing VMware environments as the logical, highly secure upgrade path for the state's upcoming FY26 storage refresh cycles.

Whitespace & Advisory: Solving the OTS Billing Friction and Unstructured Data Sprawl
The most severe, politically damaging pain point within the state government is the deeply entrenched financial friction between OTS and its client agencies regarding the fee-for-service chargeback model. Agencies are deeply frustrated by a lack of billing transparency, and OTS is heavily relying on complex Splunk queries to reverse-engineer billing accuracy.[47] Concurrently, massive modernization projects like the DCFS CCWIS overhaul are going to generate unprecedented, highly sensitive levels of unstructured data and require complex, highly secure interagency data lakes.[14]

- **The Motion:** Lead strictly with high-level Dell Advisory Services. The District Manager should position Dell not merely as a hardware vendor, but as a strategic, problem-solving partner to the newly appointed CIO, Evelina Broussard. Offer highly customized advisory engagements focused on **Data Governance, Storage Optimization, and AI Readiness**. Demonstrate exactly how Dell's **DataIQ** and unstructured data management solutions can provide OTS with granular, transparent visibility into exact agency storage consumption, directly solving their chargeback reporting anomalies and fulfilling Broussard's "Financial Operations" mandate. For the DCFS CCWIS project (slated for a July 2026 kickoff), position **Dell PowerProtect** and isolated **Cyber Recovery Vaults** as the essential, non-negotiable, StateRAMP-compliant architecture required to safeguard highly sensitive child welfare data against ransomware. This aligns perfectly with the state's broader cyber resilience mandates and ensures the state meets stringent federal OCSS compliance.

Funded Alignment: Workforce Modernization and Client Solutions Governor Landry's highly prioritized "One Door" initiative requires the Louisiana Workforce Commission to radically streamline how citizens interact with state services, moving away from disparate, confusing legacy systems toward a unified, highly accessible digital interface.[15] This requires physical and digital infrastructure to support citizens transitioning off public benefits and into job training.

- **The Motion:** Align Dell's **Client Solutions Group (CSG)** directly with the workforce modernization mandate. As the state builds out physical "One Door" vocational centers and virtual access kiosks across all 64 parishes, there will be a massive, immediate requirement for secure, easily manageable edge devices. Position Dell OptiPlex micro form factors for public kiosks, Latitude rugged devices for mobile workforce caseworkers, and highly secure Wyse thin clients as the exact endpoint architecture

required to deliver these newly integrated citizen services securely and efficiently. With the Dell NASPO contract expiring in June 2026, there is a massive, highly compelling event to lock in large-scale, statewide endpoint refreshes utilizing current FY26 budgets before the state engages in a potentially protracted contract renegotiation.

Whitespace & Advisory: DOTD Edge Infrastructure and Connected Corridors With the recent appointment of Secretary Glenn Ledet Jr. at the Department of Transportation and Development (DOTD)[74] and a massive $1.87 billion capital outlay budget for state transportation infrastructure[54], DOTD represents a significant, highly funded whitespace opportunity. Dell can position ruggedized **Client Solutions (Latitude Rugged)** for field engineering teams and **Edge Computing (Dell NativeEdge)** to process real-time telemetry from intelligent traffic systems, flood control sensors, and connected vehicle corridors securely at the edge.

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